

Cattle Production

Science

May, 2026

Cattle Production (A08762)

Short Title: Cattle Production
Faculty Science and Computing
Department Science
Cluster Agriculture
Author JDAY
Credits 5

Level: Introductory

Description of Module / Aims

This module will enable the student to gain an in-depth knowledge and the skills required to manage cattle production systems. It will enable the student to appraise the physical and financial aspects of the cattle industry. It will also allow the student to produce cattle in line with animal welfare and environmental requirements.

Programmes

AGRI-0010 BSc in Agriculture (WD_SAGUL_D)

2 / 3 / M

Indicative Content

- Factors affecting efficiency
- Feeding and management
- Suckler calf production
- Systems of cattle production
- Diseases
- Cattle facilities
- Cattle production tasks
- Economics of cattle production

Learning Outcomes

On successful completion of this module, a student will be able to:

1. Examine the future profitability of cattle production systems.
2. State factors affecting efficiency of cattle production.
3. Compare systems of cattle production.
4. Plan feeding and management programmes for a range of cattle systems.
5. Examine cattle facilities.
6. Complete safely tasks associated with cattle production with due regard to good environmental practice and the animal's health and welfare.
7. Describe good environmental practices in cattle production.
8. Describe appropriate actions to promote and maintain good animal health and welfare.

Learning and Teaching Methods

- Lectures.
- Practical instruction.
- Field trips.
- DVDs and online resources such as Animal Health Ireland, ICBF.com and .Agfood.ie.

Assessment Methods

	Weighing	Outcomes Assessed
Final Written Examination	50%	1,2,3,4,5,7,8
Continuous Assessment	50%	
<i>Practical</i>	25%	6
<i>Assignment</i>	25%	1,2,3

Assessment Criteria

<40%: Very limited knowledge and understanding of the subject matter.

40%-49%: Demonstrate a limited knowledge of the subject matter. May have some problems with critical thinking and problem-solving.

50%-59%: Demonstrate satisfactory general knowledge of the main issues within the subject. Good practical skills.

60%-69%: In addition, the student will demonstrate more detailed knowledge of all topics, and demonstrate an ability to evaluate detailed knowledge acquired in the module to new material.

70%-100%: The learner will be able to demonstrate comprehensive knowledge and understanding of all learning outcomes, and an ability to evaluate and relate topics that overlap all of the learning outcomes.

Note:

- In addition to the normal regulations, a minimum of 35% must be achieved in both the final exam and continuous assessment components of the module. In cases where continuous assessment has a practical component attendance of at least 75% in the practicals is mandatory.

Learning Modes

Learning Mode	F/T Hours	P/T Hours
Lecture	36	
Practical	12	
Independent Learning	87	

Supplementary Material

- "Animal Health Ireland." www.animalhealthireland.ie. <http://animalhealthireland.ie>
- "Department of Agriculture Food and the Marine." www.agriculture.gov.ie. <http://agriculture.gov.ie>
- "ICBF." [www.ICBF.com](http://www.icbf.com). <http://www.icbf.com>
- "Pasturebase." [www.pasturebase.teagasc.ie](http://pasturebase.teagasc.ie). <http://pasturebase.teagasc.ie>
- O'Dwyer, J. *_Beef Production Workbook_*. Carlow: Teagasc, 2011.
- Teagasc / Irish Farmers Journal, I.F.J. *_The Grazing Guide_*. Dublin: Teagasc, 2011.
- Teagasc, T. *_Teagasc Beef Manual_*. Teagasc: Teagasc, 2012.